

Table 57.2 General Statistics

Description	Bull Market, Up Breakout	Bear Market, Up Breakout	Bull Market, Down Breakout
Number found	1,361	409	284
Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence	11% R, 89% C	15% R, 85% C	90% R, 10% C
Reversal, continuation performance	45% R, 42% C	28% R, 23% C	-14% R, -18% C
Average rise or decline	42%	23%	-15%
Standard & Poor's 500 change	11%	-2%	-1%
Days to ultimate high or low	229	67	52
How many change trend?	61%	40%	27%

Average rise or decline. Notice how the average rise in bear markets, at 23%, is substantially less than the 42% rise in bull markets. The difference may be due to the market trend, where bear markets hold down bullish stocks. I guess it's like trying to light a fire when the wood is wet (unless the wetness is due to starter fluid, of course).

Standard & Poor's 500 change. Notice how the large up move in the S&P (11% rise) helped scallops with upward breakouts in bull markets perform (42% rise). Bear markets (2% decline) held down the scallop's price rise (23%) in the middle column. The results reinforce the belief that you should trade in the direction of the prevailing market trend and avoid countertrend trades.

Days to ultimate high or low. Compare the 229 days it took scallops in bull markets to climb 42% with the 67 days in bear markets to climb 23%. Prorated, the bear market rise is 1.9 times faster than the bull market. Both have price rising, too.